

Examiners' Report

Principal Examiner Feedback

October 2024

Pearson Edexcel International Award

In Lower Secondary Computing (LCP11)

Paper 01

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Section A

Question 1

(a) Candidates were asked to complete the sentence by selecting one word from the choices given.
most correctly selected 'address' to complete the sentence.

(b) This is a multiple-choice question.
'Keylogger' is the correct response.
Less than half correctly selected keylogger.

(c) In this question candidates were asked to state one reason why a data packet includes a sequence number.

Candidates found this difficult – only a small minority gave a correct answer involving 'putting packets back in the correct order after transmission' or 'the ability to send packets in any order'.

Question 2

In this question candidates were asked what is meant by the term World Wide Web.

Only a third of the cohort were able to do this. A collection of webpages or linked webpages were common accepted responses.

Question 3

This was a multiple-choice question about html.
HTML is read by a web browser. Just over half of candidates identified this correctly.

Question 4

Candidates were to complete the sentence by selecting an option from the choices given.

Question 5

Candidates were to complete the sentence by selecting an option from the choices given.

The correct option 'edit files together' was identified by the majority of the candidates.

Question 6

This question gives the name of one type of network (PAN) - and asks for another. Almost all candidates were able to do this.

Question 7 This question asked what is measured in bits per second. Approximately a third of the candidates were able to this correctly.

Question 8 This is a multiple-choice question about the purpose of a microphone. Most candidates identified the correct response.

Question 9 The question was about types of software. The example provided to guide candidates in the right direction was a type of licencing software. Other examples of licensing software are 'open source' or 'free' which are included in the mark scheme. However, different software types were also accepted (application software, utility software etc.).

The vast majority of candidates were awarded the one mark available for this question.

Question 10 Candidates were asked to complete a sentence by selecting an option from the choices given.
Almost all of the candidates were successful.

Question 11 (a) Candidates were asked to complete a sentence by selecting an option from the choices given.
Most of the candidates selected the correct option.

(b) Candidates were asked to complete the sentence by selecting an option from the choices given.
Almost all of the candidates selected the correct option.

(c) This was a multiple-choice question.
Fewer candidates selected the correct option for this part than in parts (a) and (b).

Question 12 This question requires candidates to link three types of storage to a device that uses it. Almost half of the candidates completed the task successfully for all three types of storage. Most completed the task successfully for two types of storage.

Question 13 This question involves coding in Python. Three lines of Python code were included in the question and used in each part of the question.

(a) Candidates were asked to complete a sentence by selecting one option from the choices given in the question. Less than a third were successful.

(b) This was a multiple-choice question about the data structure used in the code. Almost double the number of candidates were successful compared with (a).

(c) This was a multiple-choice question with a similar number of the candidates as in part (b) gaining the mark.

Question 14 This is a multipart question involving four lines of Python code provided in the question.

(a) Candidates were asked to state the number of the line that assigns a string value.
This is line 2: ‘ word = “tree” ‘
Just over half were able to identify the correct line.

(b)The four lines of code included and error. Candidates were asked to explain the error in the code. One mark was allocated for identification of the **type** of error – in this case a syntax error in line 3 - with a second mark for more information. A significant minority of candidates were able to provide the type of error and why this was an error. Less than half gained at least one mark.

(c) The final part of the question used multiple-choice. A majority of candidates gained the mark.

Question 15 In this question candidates were asked to complete the output for each line of code in the table. Over half the cohort were unable to do this.

Question 16 In this question candidates were asked to state two ways digital technologies can harm the environment. Approximately, a third of the cohort each could either: give two suitable ways; give only one way; couldn’t give any at all.

Question 17 In this question candidates were asked for two responsible ways to respond to inappropriate conduct online. Most candidates were able to give one way.

Question 18 This multipart question involved the use of binary.

(a)Most candidates knew the number of bytes in a kibibyte.

(b) This was a multiple-choice question involving binary addition.
Almost all of the candidates were able to identify the correct response.

(c) This question asked candidates to state the number of bits in a binary pattern. The answer required them to count the bits, in this case 8. Only two thirds of the cohort gave the correct answer.

(d) In this part of the question candidates had to state the character set need to encode an emoji. Just over a third identified Unicode.

Question 19 This is a multipart question involving a bubble sort. Working space was provided on the paper for the candidates to carry out the sort using the values given and then to answer the questions. Few candidates took advantage of this.

(a)(i) Less than a third of candidates gave the correct number of swaps.

(a)(ii) Most gave the correct value in the last position.

(b) Less than half gave the correct number of passes to sort the list.

(c) This was the most challenging part of the overall question. A good proportion of candidates gained at least one mark but only very few could fully answer the question.

(d) Most gave the name of a correct search algorithm.

Question 20 This is a multipart question about binary representation of sound and images.

(a) Over half of the candidates partly described have the representation of sound improves when bit-depth is increased, with few giving a full answer.

(b) A vey small number of candidates achieved full marks for their description of how a bitmap image is

represented in binary. Two thirds gave suitable partial descriptions for 1 or 2 marks.

Question 21 This question asked candidates to complete the code for a computer game by filling in blanks.

Candidates found this question difficult, none gained all four marks.

Under two thirds of the cohort could achieve at least half-marks for this question with a further smaller proportion managing to achieve 1 mark.

Section B

Question 22 This is a multipart question about databases.

(a) This was a multiple-choice question about linking tables in a database.
A third of candidates rightly selected option B-Primary keys.

(b) This was a multiple-choice question about a foreign key.
A majority of candidates correctly selected option C.

(c) This was a multiple-choice question about a logical operator used in a database query.
A similar number of candidates as in part (b) correctly identified option D-NOT.

(d) Candidates were to complete the sentence about a datatype by selecting one option from the choices given.
Most candidates correctly selected 'Boolean'.

Question 23 Candidates were to complete the sentence by selecting one option from the choices given.
Almost all of the candidates correctly selected 'brightness'.

Question 24 This was a multiple-choice question. Candidates were asked to identify which tool would be used the change the dimensions of an image.

D - resize was the correct answer and most candidates selected this option.

Question 25 In this question candidates were asked to state one reason for compressing a file before sharing it online. Making the transfer quicker or reducing the file size were popular correct responses.
Under two thirds of candidates gave a correct answer.

Question 26 In this question candidates were asked to state one way in which a vector graphic is different from a bitmap graphic. Just over half were correct.

Question 27 This was a multipart question about presentations.

(a) Candidates were to complete a sentence by selecting one word from the choices given.
Multimedia was correctly selected by most candidates.

(b) Candidates were to complete a sentence by selecting one word from the choices given.
Images was correctly selected by almost all candidates.

Question 28 This was a multiple-choice question about files.

Most candidates selected the correct response-
Permissions

Question 29 This was a multiple-choice question about access to software over the Internet.
Just under half of candidates selected the correct response-**hosted applications.**

Question 30 This question asked for one reason for using page breaks in documents.
Under half of candidates gave a suitable reason.

Question 31 This was a multipart question about documents.
An image of a document was included in the question.

(a) Candidates were asked to state two formatting options used in the letter. Bold/font enhancement, alignment and paragraph spacing were all valid responses as they had been used in the letter.
Over two thirds of candidates successfully identified as least one formatting option visible in the letter.

(b) Candidates were asked to state one way a memo differs from a letter.
Over two thirds of were able to do this.

Question 32 This is a multipart question about a spreadsheet whose image is given in the question.

(a) Candidates were asked to state the number formatting option that would be used in cell C4.

Just over half of candidates correctly identified 'percentage'.

(b) Candidates were asked to identify the type of chart to show the number of books each student had been read. Most were able to do this.

(c) Candidates we ask to write the formula that would be used in cell C8.
This proved problematic for many candidates. Less than half gained at least one mark but only a small number were about to give a fully correct formula.

(d) Candidates were asked to explain one reason why multiple worksheets would be used to track students' monthly reading. Less than half of the candidates gaining 1 or 2 marks though only very few gained 2.

Question 33 In this question candidates were asked to describe house style.

This was not well answered. Less than half found it difficult to gain any marks.

Question 34 In this question candidates are asked to explain why it is important to use a range of sources of information before using the information in a presentation.

Good explanations were seen and the majority of candidates gained 1 or 2 marks.

Question 35 This multipart question included an image of a web page. Candidates found both parts difficult, especially part (a).

(a) This question asks candidates to state the type of html elements that would be linked to.

A tiny number of candidates gained a mark for their response to (a).

(b) Candidates are given an example of using html to improve the appearance of the webpage and asked to provide another.

Candidates had more success with part (b) with a good proportion having some success.

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